



Open Competition ENW-M

Round 2026-2027

Call for proposals

Dutch Research Council Science

2026 - 2027



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1 Summary and introduction

This chapter contains a brief summary of the round and an introduction.

The whole text of this Call for proposals has been published in both Dutch and English. The Dutch version is deemed authentic. For legal interpretation the text of the Dutch version will be decisive.

1.1 Brief summary

Title: Open Competition ENW-M.

Aim: ENW-M grants are intended for curiosity-driven scientific research with impact. The ENW-M grants offer researchers the opportunity and freedom to start, and/or strengthen excellent, challenging and innovative lines of research, both mono disciplinary, multidisciplinary and interdisciplinary. ENW-M funding focuses on small-scale research projects in which a concrete research project is central.

Budget: The maximum grant available per project is €400,000 for ENW-M-1 and ENW-M-1-Weave grants, €800,000 for ENW-M-1X and ENW-M-2 grants.

Co-funding requirement: Not permitted

Supporting contributions: None

Submission deadlines: Applications for the round 2026-2027 can be submitted until 31 July 2027 at the latest, as long as the maximum number of 420 applications has not yet been reached.

Procedure: The application procedure consists of peer review by reviewers, a rebuttal, classification into packages and clusters, preliminary advice and meetings of the cluster committees, and decision-making.

1.2 Introduction

This Call for proposals describes the application process for the “Open Competition ENW-M, round 2026-2027” and the conditions for bilateral applications via the Weave principle. This Call for proposals consists of seven chapters. This Call for proposals falls under the responsibility of the Dutch Research Council (NWO).

The [NWO Grant Rules 2024](#) and [Approval of Funding for Scientific Research](#) apply to all proposals.

NWO processes personal data it receives in the context of this round in accordance with the [NWO Privacy Statement](#).

This Call for Proposals uses abbreviations for the different application types, such as ENW-M-1-X and ENW-M-1-Weave. These abbreviations are defined in section 3.4. A number of terms are also introduced for Weave. A list of definitions is included in section 7.5.

1.3 Changes since the previous Call for proposals

The Call for proposals Open Competition Domain Science-M, round 2026-2027 is a further development of the ENW-M call of recent years. Compared to the Call for proposals of Open Competition Domain Science-M, round 2025-2026, the following changes have been made:

- Additional submission requirements for main- and co-applicants:
Applicants with ongoing Open Competition Domain Science-M projects (including Weave projects) and project leaders of ongoing projects within the Open Technology Programme (OTP), the SSH Open Competition (M and L), the ZonMw Open Competition or the NWO and ZonMw Talent Programme (Veni, Vidi and Vici) may only submit a proposal for the Open Competition Domain Science-M 2026–2027 two years prior to the planned end date of their project.
- In round 2026-2027, 5 packages with a maximum of 84 applications will be taken into consideration. A total of 420 applications will be taken into consideration.
- The definition of criterion I (Scientific quality of the proposal) and criterion II (Scientific and/or societal impact) has been adjusted compared to the OC ENW-M call 2025-2026.

2 Aim and background

This chapter provides information about the aim and background of the programme and the round.

2.1 Aim of the programme and the round

ENW-M grants are intended for curiosity-driven fundamental scientific research with impact. Impact includes both scientific and societal impact, and the programme allows a choice between scientific impact, societal impact, or both; see the assessment criteria in Section 4.1. Section 2.2.2 explains how societal impact is interpreted within the programme, which focuses on curiosity-driven fundamental scientific research.

ENW-M grants give researchers the opportunity and freedom to initiate or to build on excellent, challenging and innovative research lines, both mono disciplinary, multidisciplinary and interdisciplinary. ENW-M funding focuses on small-scale research projects in which a concrete research project is central. An investment may be crucial to properly carry out the high-quality proposed research. Research projects in method development or instrumentation development also fall within the scope of this funding instrument. These projects, like the other proposals, are assessed based on quality and impact as specified in section 4.1.

This funding instrument is open for proposals with a research question in or overlapping the fields of earth sciences, astronomy, chemistry, computer science, life sciences, physics and mathematics. Proposals can be both mono disciplinary, multidisciplinary and interdisciplinary. For applications with a (partial) domain-overarching and/or ZonMw component, the core of the research proposal should fit one or more of the seven disciplines of the Domain Science, see Section 3.5.1. The Domain Science disciplines are listed in Section 7.1.

2.2 Background

NWO advances world-class scientific research. Scientific research – fundamental, applied and practice-oriented research – plays a key role in shaping our society. Through their independent, reliable and world-class research, researchers expand the frontiers of our knowledge and capabilities with their creativity and perseverance.

NWO Domain Science (NWO-domein Exacte en Natuurwetenschappen (ENW)) wants to provide opportunity for wonder, discovery, unexpected links and inspiration. Within the Open Competition of the Domain Science, NWO finances curiosity-driven research within the research areas of the Domain Science. The research subject is of your own choice without specific thematic prerequisites.

There are three types of funding in the NWO Open Competition Domain Science: XS, M and XL which all have their specific aim and conditions. A promising idea can be quickly explored with a Domain Science-XS-grant and can be further explored with a Domain Science-M-grant. The Domain Science-XL-grants allow for the advancement of the research idea into a world-class, challenging and innovative research line by combining the expertise and strengths of multiple research groups to work together in a consortium. For more information about the Domain Science-XS and -XL grants we refer you to the respective Call for proposals on the NWO webpage.

2.2.1 Non-thematic international cooperation through Weave

Weave is a cross-European initiative set up by European research funders and embedded in Science Europe through which 12 European research funders currently fund cross-border research with partner countries, see <https://Weave-research.net/>. Through the lead agency principle, researchers can collaborate bottom-up with partners from member countries/regions, for proposals concerning a fundamental research question. The aim of Weave is to simplify assessment procedures by having applicants submit to a single research funder ('lead agency') that is responsible for further scientific evaluation. Upon granting, the other countries' research funders ('partner agencies') fund their 'own researchers' and thus typically follow the decision of the lead agency where the proposal was submitted.

NWO is not an official partner within the Weave consortium yet, but is exploring whether it could eventually become one. To this end, the Domain Science is running a pilot within this Call for proposals with partners from Germany, Luxembourg and Flanders. NWO has made agreements with the Deutsche Forschungsgemeinschaft (DFG) in Germany, the Fonds National de la Recherche (FNR) in Luxembourg and with the Fonds Wetenschappelijk Onderzoek - Vlaanderen (FWO) on funding bilateral projects according to the Weave principle. Cooperation with one or more German, Luxembourgish or Flemish researchers is possible by submitting a Weave proposal to DFG, FNR, FWO or NWO. Projects with partners from more than one country, involving three or four research funders, are excluded for the time being.

Where this Call for proposals refers to a 'Dutch applicant', it means an applicant working at the institutions defined in section 3.1, and therefore does not refer to the nationality of the applicant. 'German, Luxembourgish or Flemish (co-)applicant' refers to an applicant who meets the submission requirements of DFG, FNR or FWO respectively, and therefore does not refer to the nationality/origin of the applicant.

If the proposal is submitted in the Netherlands, NWO acts as lead agency (ENW-M-1-Weave). In that case the proposal will be considered and assessed in accordance with the application procedure as described in this Call for proposals. Where this Call for proposals refers to 'submission to NWO' this refers to both national ENW-M proposals and bilateral ENW-M-1-Weave proposals (where NWO is the lead agency).

When the proposal is submitted to DFG, FNR or FWO, NWO acts as partner agency. The application is then processed according to the evaluation procedure of the lead agency's funding instrument. If NWO acts as partner agency, NWO checks amongst other things whether the Dutch co-applicant and the Dutch part of the budget meet the conditions of this Call for proposals. To this end the proposal must be submitted administratively to NWO (administrative submission). The conditions and the full procedure if NWO acts as partner agency are described in section 7.4. Section 7.5 includes a Weave glossary.

2.2.2 Societal impact of research

New knowledge and insights from scientific research can make an important contribution to developing solutions for the various issues society faces. By facilitating greater interaction and alignment between researchers and potential knowledge users, the chance of knowledge utilisation increases, as well as the likelihood of generating societal impact. Societal impact here stands for changes that (partly) result from research-generated knowledge and skills. These changes contribute to the well-being of people, planet and society for this and future generations. Through its policy on impact, NWO promotes the potential contribution that research can make to societal issues by encouraging productive interactions with societal stakeholders, both during the development stage and the subsequent implementation of research. It does so in a manner that is in accordance with the aim of the particular funding instrument. NWO encourages researchers to reflect on the potential desired and undesired impact of their research from a broad perspective. Scientific impact is the broadening or deepening of one's own or other scientific fields through new knowledge and/or expertise.

In this programme, the Impact Outlook approach is applied. Here, researchers can choose which type of impact they want to specifically focus on, while proportional consideration is also given to what can be done for the remaining impact.

NWO offers an e-learning module that can help interested parties via [Online impact workshops | NWO](#). For more information on our policy on impact, please visit the website: [Knowledge utilisation | NWO](#).

3 Preparation and submission

This chapter contains information on how to prepare and submit a proposal.

The use of generative AI when preparing a proposal is not explicitly prohibited as long as this happens responsibly. For guidance, see the [NWO policy on the use of generative artificial intelligence \(GAI\) | NWO](#).

3.1 Timeline

You can submit your proposal at any moment **from 18 August 2026 up to and including 31 July 2027, 14:00:00 CEST**, as long as the maximum number of 420 applications has not yet been reached. An exception is made for ENW-M-1-Weave proposals with FWO as partner agency, which may be submitted **to and including 24 November 2027 14:00:00 CET**.

NWO will consider the applications in the order that they are received. The original submission date and submission time of a proposal that meets the conditions for submission shall determine the order of consideration. You will be notified as soon as the timeline for the assessment of your proposal is known.

The call OC ENW-M, round 2026-2027 will be closed by the board of the NWO domain Science (domain board ENW) as soon as the 84th proposal in the 5th package has been taken into consideration (total 420th proposal) or on 31 July 2027. In that case, it will be stated on the NWO funding page that the Open Competition ENW-M has been paused. It is expected that applications can be submitted again from August 2027 in the 2027-2028 round, for which the Call for Proposals will be published in due course.

Applications submitted after the deadline of round 2026-2027 or after NWO has to close round 2026-2027 (as described above), will not be taken into consideration by NWO.

If an ENW-M-1-Weave proposal is submitted to NWO, an administrative submission of the proposal to the foreign partner agency must also be made within seven calendar days of submission to NWO.

If funding is requested for project-specific costs of a foreign research organisation, the foreign organisation must be assessed by NWO prior to submitting an application to determine whether it may participate as a co-applicant. For the purpose of this assessment, the applicant shall submit the documents referred to in paragraph 7.2.2 by email to ENW-M@nwo.nl no later than 20 working days before submission.

3.2 Who can apply

Full, associate and assistant professors and other researchers with a comparable position* may submit an application if they have a tenured position (and therefore a paid position for an indefinite period) or a tenure track agreement at one of the following organisations:

- universities, as described in Section 1.8, subsection 1 of the Dutch Higher Education and Research Act, or universities referred to in the [Policy Rules for Universities](#) in the Kingdom of the Netherlands;

- university medical centres, as described in Section 1.13, subsection 1 of the Higher Education and Research Act;
- [KNAW institutes](#) and [NWO institutes](#);
- Netherlands Cancer Institute;
- Max Planck Institute for Psycholinguistics in Nijmegen;
- Naturalis Biodiversity Center;
- Advanced Research Centre for NanoLithography (ARCNL);
- Princess Máxima Center;
- The Royal Netherlands Meteorological Institute (KNMI);
- IHE Delft Institute for Water Education.

*A comparable position refers to a researcher that has a demonstrable and comparable number of years of experience in carrying out scientific research and supervising other researchers as a full, associate or assistant professor.

** Persons with a contract for a limited period of time (other than a tenure track appointment) may not submit a proposal, except for the following exception. Researchers with a one-year or a two-year employment contract who are expected to be offered a permanent employment contract after the initial one-year or two-year period has elapsed, are also eligible to submit a proposal. In such cases, applicants should add a statement from their employer, confirming that the relevant organization will offer the applicant a permanent position if their performance meets the required standards. Persons with a zero-hour employment agreement may not submit a proposal.

It may be that the main applicant or a co-applicant's tenure track employment contract ends before the intended completion date of the project for which grant funding is being requested, or that the main or co-applicant's tenure agreement ends before this date due to their reaching retirement age. In such cases, the proposal must include a statement from the employer. In this statement, the research organisation in question guarantees that the project and all project members for whom funding is being requested will receive adequate supervision for the full duration of the project. The person taking over project supervision must comply with the conditions for applicants as set out in paragraph 3.2.

3.2.1 Additional conditions for main applicants and co-applicants

Additional conditions (applicable to both main applicants and co-applicants):

- ENW-M-1 and ENW-M-1X (see section 3.4) have a single main applicant and no co-applicants.
- ENW-M-2 has a single main applicant and a single co-applicant who work together and whose expertise is complementary. Main applicant and co-applicant may be employed by the same organization, as long as their expertise is complementary.
- On the NWO side, ENW-M-1-Weave has one applicant.
- On the NWO side, ENW-M-1-Weave has one main applicant who meets the conditions set out in this Call for proposals and one or more co-applicants who meet the conditions of DFG, FNR or FWO. Applications with partners from more than one country are not allowed.
- For ENW-M-1-Weave applications submitted to NWO, the Dutch applicant should be the lead applicant. Additional Dutch co-applicants are not allowed.
- The main applicant and co-applicant may have only one Open Competition ENW-M application, including a Weave application, assessed at a time.
- After substantive consideration and rejection of an ENW-M proposal, including a Weave proposal, regardless whether NWO or DFG/FNR/FWO is lead agency, Dutch applicants are subject to a mandatory waiting period of 12 calendar months before a new application may be

submitted, regardless of whether a researcher is involved in the role of lead or co-applicant. This period starts from the original submission date of a proposal that meets the conditions for submission

- Main- and co-applicants may only submit a OC ENW-M proposal two years prior to the planned end date of their last ending NWO Open Competition-project (Open Competition ENW-M, Open Technology programme (OTP), Open Competition SSH (M or L), Open Competition ZonMw) or NWO Talent programme-project. This applies to both the main- and co-applicant for ongoing Open Competition ENW-M projects. For ongoing OTP, OC-SGW M, OC-SGW L, OC-ZonMw, Veni, Vidi, and Vici projects, this applies only to the project leader (eq. main applicant) of the ongoing project. The period of a current project is defined from the signing date of the official letter to the planned end date (as indicated in ISAAC).
- If the budget module Money follows Cooperation (MfC) is included in an ENW-M-2 proposal, the foreign knowledge institution of the co-applicant must meet the requirements in Article 1.1, paragraph 4 and 5 of the NWO Grant Rules 2024, with the exception of the condition that the co-applicant must be established in the Kingdom of the Netherlands (see Section 7.2.2).

3.2.2. Preferential treatment for new tenured members of staff and tenure trackers

To simplify the acquisition of funding for starting researchers they can make use of a one-off request for preferential treatment. This only applies to ENW-M-1 proposals (and not ENW-M-1X, ENW-M-1-Weave, or ENW-M-2 proposals). Starting researchers must satisfy the following requirements:

- the starting researcher is at the beginning of their scientific career;
- the starting researcher has the option to apply for a preferential treatment during two years. This two-year period is calculated from the first temporary or tenured appointment as referred to in Section 3.2, whichever comes first;
- prior to the submission date, the starting researcher has not received any previous support in the Open Competition Domain Science M (including Weave applications) or XL, in its predecessors or in the form of a Vidi or Vici grant from the NWO Talent Programme;
- the starting researcher has not previously requested this preferential treatment or its predecessor.

For applicants requesting preferential treatment and for whom the final submission date falls during the period that the call for proposals OC ENW-M, round 2026-2027 has been closed and round 2027-2028 will be opened, the final submission date is extended till 14 September 2028.

Extension clause

The extension clause allows applicants requesting preferential treatment under ENW-M-1 an extension to their two-year application deadline if they can demonstrate that they have taken a period of care leave or sick leave during that period, or that they have had one or more children during that period. It is not only applicants who have been absent from work due to pregnancy leave or maternity leave who are eligible for the extension clause. Applicants on adoption leave, partners' leave and leave in relation to the arrival of a foster child are also eligible for the extension clause.

Upon applying for preferential treatment, the biological mother of the child is entitled to an extension of 16 weeks per child and the other parent is eligible for an extension of 5 weeks per child. In addition, the length of parental leave taken is compensated. Extensions for parents are only granted if the children are part of the same household. In the case of long-term illness or care leave involving a first-degree relative, any reduction in working time is compensated. In all cases, the maximum extension is one year.

How do you request preferential treatment (with extension)?

To request preferential treatment, the application must be accompanied by a separate covering letter in which the applicant outlines the extent to which the conditions mentioned above are fulfilled (see the template available on the website). If you make use of the extension clause, a statement must also be provided by your organization showing when exactly you took abovementioned leave. The manner in which NWO applies preferential treatment is described in Section 4.3.8.

3.3 Available budget

The subsidy ceiling for proposals submitted to NWO for the period is € 45,000,000. The budget available will be distributed according to the following:

- a maximum of five packages, each consisting of a maximum of three clusters, will be taken into consideration in the period mentioned;
- The first three packages each consists of up to 84 proposals that will complete the assessment procedure. A package will be closed once 84 proposals have been taken into consideration in that package;
- for each package, approximately € 9,000,000 is available. From this, an amount of € 1,200,000 will be earmarked for at most three proposals that will be awarded funding via preferential treatment;
- the distribution of the subsidy ceiling per package among the clusters follows a weighted distribution based on total budget requested per cluster;
- for each package, first the highest-ranked proposals up to € 7,800,000 will be awarded funding. These are the regular allocations. Subsequently, from the earmarked amount, a maximum of three proposals will be additionally awarded funding via preferential treatment, one in each cluster. N.B. this will not include the proposals already allocated funding via the regular route that are also eligible for preferential treatment;
- An ENW-M-1-Weave proposal must finish in the top 6 of the ranking per cluster to be awarded. If a Weave proposal ends up outside the top 6 of the ranking per cluster and the NWO-part of the Weave proposal falls within the available budget of the cluster, NWO can consult with the partner agency about awarding of the relevant Weave proposal. In this case awarding will depend on the financial scope available to the partner agency;
- If there are residual budgets in the clusters, the combined residual budget is allocated according to the method described in section 4.2.6.

If for the last package less than 84 proposals, but at least 28 admissible proposals, are submitted, then the last package will consist of these proposals. The budget available for awarding funding to the highest-ranked proposals and the budget for awarding grants to the proposals with a preferential treatment will, in that case, be proportionately reduced. If in the last package, fewer than 28 admissible proposals are submitted, then these proposals will be added to the penultimate package. The budget available for awarding funding to the highest-ranked proposals and the budget for awarding grants to proposals with a preferential treatment will, in that case, be proportionately increased.

3.4 What can be applied for

The ENW-M program has different types of applications that are described below. The project's proposed duration cannot exceed 6 years. The applicant and co-applicants can include costs for personnel, materials, investments and knowledge utilisation. The available budget modules are given below. Request only the amounts of funding necessary to complete the project. Rates and explanations of these budget modules are given in Section 7.2.

Note: Funding for clinical trials cannot be applied for.

ENW-M-1

An ENW-M-1 grant has a maximum size of € 400,000 and has a single main applicant and no co-applicants. The grant must be used for a single temporary scientific position (PhD or postdoc) in combination with the other budget modules available. The Scientific personnel at foreign research organisations module is not available for this type of grant.

ENW-M-1-X

An ENW-M-1 proposal can be extended to include an investment required for the research to be carried out. This variant is called ENW-M-1X. This concerns projects with an investment character, for which a top-up is possible. If more than €150,000 in investment is requested, the maximum budget is increased from €400,000 to €400,000 plus the value of the investment, up to a maximum size of €800,000. An ENW-M-1X has one main applicant and no co-applicants. The funding must be used for one temporary scientific position (PhD or postdoc) and an investment via the Investment module, in combination with the other available budget modules. The Scientific personnel at foreign research organisations module is not available in this funding form.

ENW-M-1-Weave

An ENW-M-1-Weave proposal has one Dutch lead applicant and one or more co-applicants from Germany, Luxembourg or Flanders working together to carry out the proposed research. Dutch co-applicants are not allowed. The maximum funding requested from NWO is €400,000. The funding applied for at NWO must be used for one temporary scientific position (PhD (not possible in case of a Weave proposal with DFG) or postdoc) in combination with the other available budget modules. The Scientific personnel at foreign research organisations module is not available in this funding form. Funding requested via Weave from DFG, FNR or FWO can be spent in accordance with the conditions set by DFG, FNR or FWO.

ENW-M-2

An ENW-M-2 grant has a maximum size of € 800,000 and has a single main applicant and a single co-applicant who work together to realise the proposed research. Main applicant and co-applicant may be employed by the same organisation, as long as their expertise is complementary. The grant must be used for two temporary scientific positions (PhD or postdoc) in combination with the other budget modules available. The scientific positions must be equally allocated across both collaborating applicants.

3.4.1 Cooperation with researchers abroad

Within this Call for proposals, there are several options to apply for funding to collaborate with researchers abroad. Please contact NWO (see section 6) if you would like more information about this.

- travel and accommodation expenses for foreign guest researchers can be reimbursed through the Material budget module;
- travel and accommodation costs (including working visits, internships, and research stays) for the requested personnel positions are eligible within the Material budget module. Project-related services, such as (laboratory) analyses by a foreign partner, are also reimbursable within the Material budget module;
- the Scientific personnel at foreign research organisations module gives the possibility to carry out part of the project at a knowledge institution with a public task outside the Netherlands, for

example by appointing a temporary scientific employee at that knowledge institution in an ENW-M-2 application. For more information, see the notes to the budget modules in section 7.2.

Specific arrangements exist in this Call for proposals for the appointment of temporary scientific personnel in collaborative projects with researchers from Germany, Luxembourg and Flanders (see below). As a result of the lead agency principle underlying the agreements with Germany, Luxembourg and Flanders, it is not possible to use Scientific personnel at foreign research organisations module for these countries/regions in an ENW-M-2 application.

Collaboration with Germany, Luxembourg or Flanders

NWO has made agreements with DFG, FNR and FWO to (co)fund bilateral projects according to the Weave principle. With NWO as lead agency, an ENW-M-1 proposal can be extended with at least one co-applicant from Germany, Luxembourg or from Flanders, creating an ENW-M-1-Weave proposal. Proposals with partners from more than one country are excluded for the current round. The foreign component does not count in determining maximum budget size on the Dutch side. Funding can be requested for a maximum of 3 years in an ENW-M-1-Weave application with DFG as partner agency. Accordingly, it is not possible to apply for a PhD student on the Dutch side in an ENW-M-1-Weave application with Germany. Funding for a maximum of 4 years can be applied for in an ENW-M-1-Weave with FNR or FWO as partner agency.

For submission conditions of the German co-applicant, see [the DFG website](#) | [Weave](#).

For submission conditions of the Luxembourgish co-applicant, see [the FNR website](#) | [Weave](#).

For submission conditions of the Flemish co-applicant, see [the FWO website](#) | [Weave FWO as partner agency](#) and [FWO Junior and Senior research project](#).

The conditions that apply if NWO acts as partner agency and DFG, FNR or FWO acts as lead agency are described in section 7.4.

3.4.2 Personnel

It is possible to apply for funding of the salary costs of personnel contributing to the project. The amounts depend on the type of appointment and the organisation employing the personnel in question.

Personnel at a university in the Kingdom of the Netherlands, university medical centre or research organisation

For personnel employed by a university in the Kingdom of the Netherlands, university medical centre or other research organisation as referred to in Article 1.1, first section, subsections c to h of the NWO Grant Rules 2024, salary costs may be included for the following positions: PhD student, postdoc and non-scientific personnel.

Scientific personnel at foreign research organisations

It is possible to include salary costs for scientific personnel at foreign research organisations who are co-applicants. This budget module is only available for ENW-M-2 applications.

A maximum of 50% of the grant amount may be requested for personnel of foreign research organisations.

Note: Prior to submission of the proposal, NWO will assess a foreign organisation's compliance with Article 1.1, subsections 4 and 5 of the NWO Grant Rules 2024 (see subsections 3.4.1 and 7.2.2).

3.4.3 Materials

All project-specific material costs are eligible for funding. A maximum of 50% may be applied to work by partners and/or third parties.

Only for ENW-M-2 applications: up to 50% of the grant amount for materials may be requested for foreign research organisations.

3.4.4 Investments

Funding may be requested for investments in equipment, infrastructure and other research resources that will retain economic value after use or can be re-used. Salary costs for personnel to set up equipment, infrastructure or other research resources may be included as part of the investment. The Personnel rates and conditions apply and these costs must be included as Investments. Investments are only possible at research organisations listed in subsection 3.2.

A maximum of €500,000 may be requested for investments.

3.4.5 Knowledge utilisation

Funding may be requested for activities that promote the use of knowledge generated by the research¹, increasing the research's societal impact.

It is possible to allocate up to 5% of the grant amount to this module. Use of this module is not mandatory.

Only for ENW-M-2 applications: up to 50% of the grant amount for knowledge utilisation may be requested for foreign research organisations.

3.5 Preparing and submitting a proposal in ISAAC

NWO makes use of the [ISAAC](#) system. Start preparations for your ISAAC proposal submission in good time.

The steps involved in writing your application are:

- create an account or update your existing account details if necessary;
- use ISAAC to download the proposal form and required formats for annexes;
- save the completed proposal form as a PDF file and submit it in ISAAC. Submit any annexes separately;
- in ISAAC, fill in all the requested information, including the [NOW disciplines](#) a summary for non-experts in Dutch and English; NWO will publish this summary for non-experts along with the press release about the grant awards. It should have a length of 50–100 words and be written for a general audience. Due to intellectual property concerns, no scientific summary is published;

¹ All activities included in this budget module must fit the European Commission's definition of 'knowledge transfer activities' in the State aid framework for research and development and innovation (OJ 2022, C 414).

- if you need to register an organisation that isn't yet included in the ISAAC database, this is possible until five working days before the deadline by email to relatiebeheer@nwo.nl;
- the proposal is in English.

It is mandatory to upload the following annexes to the proposal in ISAAC:

- budget (for the budget requested from NWO) – always mandatory;
- budget of the budget requested from the foreign partner (DFG, FNR, FWO) – mandatory for a bilateral application for which NWO is the lead agency;
- declaration of appointment and project supervision - mandatory for Dutch applicant whose appointment does not cover the entire duration of the project and mandatory in case of application for preferential treatment;

Optional annex(es) only:

- request for preferential treatment;
- declaration of support from collaboration partners, without co-funding;
- quotation from external party that provides (an indication of) the cost of the requested investment.

Always use the templates provided by NWO for all annexes. Annexes other than those listed above are not permitted. All attachments, with the exception of the budget, must be submitted as PDF files (without security). The budget must be submitted as an Excel file in ISAAC.

Documentation including proposal submission formats is also available on the funding page for this round on the NWO website.

For questions about ISAAC, use the 'Help' button in ISAAC to consult the ISAAC manual or contact the ISAAC helpdesk. The ISAAC helpdesk can be reached Monday to Friday between 10:00 and 17:00 at +31 (0) 70 34 40 600. Emails may be sent to isaac.helpdesk@nwo.nl. You will receive a reply within two working days.

3.5.1 Advice on suitable connection

Be sure to consider whether the proposal has a suitable connection with the aim of the programme in good time, as for this round, proposals must fit the Science domain. In case of doubt, e.g. if a proposal relates to multiple domains and/or has a ZonMw character reach out to the contact for the programme well before the submission deadline. They can provide advice on the proposal's suitable connection for this round. The final decision is up to the applicant. See Section 6 for contact details.

3.5.2 Co-funding

For this Call for proposals, co-funding is not permitted.

3.6 Requirements for consideration

NWO checks that a proposal meets all the conditions applicable to this Call for proposals, including those set out below. A proposal must meet these requirements to be taken into consideration.

Conditions:

- the proposal was received before the deadline;

- the main applicant and optional co-applicant(s) of an ENW-M-2 application meet the conditions stated in subsection 3.2 and in case of a foreign co-applicant subsection 7.2.2;
- the proposal complies with the DORA guidelines described in subsection 4.3.4;
- the proposal meets the additional submission requirements as described in section 3.2.1;
- the proposal has been prepared using the forms provided in ISAAC and on the NWO website's funding page (web page) for this round;
- the data management section (showing how the applicants will handle data generated by the research) has been completed;
- the proposal form and the required annexes are, after a possible one-time request to make additions or changes, correct and complete and have been filled out according to the instructions;
- the proposal has been submitted via the main applicant's ISAAC account;
- the proposal is in English;
- the proposal meets the page count and word limit requirements;
- the budget for the proposal has been compiled according to the requirements of this Call for proposals, using the provided format with the most recent rates;
- the proposed project has a duration of at most 6 years. Exception: a proposed ENW-M-1-Weave project with Germany, Luxembourg or Flanders has a maximum duration of 3 (in the case of DFG) and 4 years (in the case of FNR and FWO), respectively;
- for ENW-M-1-Weave applications: the corresponding administrative submission has been submitted to the foreign partner (DFG, FNR or FWO) on time and meets the foreign partner's requirements.

The proposal form may include additional requirements, explanations, procedures and questions necessary for the form's correct completion.

Consideration of proposal and administrative corrections

After submission of the required documents, the applicant receives notice of whether NWO intends to take the proposal into consideration as soon as possible. Be aware that NWO may contact applicants for up to two weeks after the submission deadline to request any administrative corrections required to allow the conditions for submission to be met. In the case of ENW-M-1-Weave proposals you should expect a longer period before you will be contacted by NWO to request any administrative corrections due to the formal checks by the partner agency and coordination between the two organisations. The applicant is given one opportunity to make these corrections, and must do so within five working days. If the corrected documents remain incomplete and/or incorrect, NWO will not take the proposal into further consideration.

Notification of own research organisation

NWO works on the assumption that applicants have informed the research organisations where they are employed about the proposal submission, and that these organisations have accepted the grant conditions pertaining to this Call for proposals. During the application process, NWO will communicate with the main applicant.

4 Assessment

This chapter contains information on the assessment procedure for a proposal.

4.1 Criteria

The assessment is based on substantive assessment criteria and commences once a proposal has been taken into consideration. Proposals are substantively assessed against the following criteria:

1. Scientific quality of the proposal (What) (75% weighting in assessment)

This includes:

- the clarity of the proposal, question posed and the objectives;
- scientifically innovative and/or groundbreaking elements of the research proposal;
- alignment with the aim of the call, as detailed in Section 2.1;
- the scientific approach: (challenge in) the approach and the feasibility of this;
- the effectiveness in terms of methodology and/or investment proposed;
- appropriate expertise of the researchers involved, appropriate embedding of the research and access to the equipment needed;
- the requested budget and its justification, and if applicable, the necessity for an investment within an ENW-M-1X;
- in the case of an ENW-M-1-Weave or ENW-M-2 proposal, the collaboration between the applicants must have a clear added value. In which way does the collaboration offer more than the sum of the individual researchers?

2. Scientific and/or societal impact (Why) (25% weighting in assessment)

Applicants can choose to focus in their research project on scientific impact, societal impact, or a combination of both types of impact.

The assessment regarding the achievement of scientific and/or societal impact includes:

- the extent to which the project has added value for scientific and/or societal impact;
- potential for scientific and/or societal impact in the short and long term;
- whether the proposal conveys an ambitious vision regarding the way(s) in which the proposed research may lead to scientific and/or societal impact;
- the extent to which the motivation for the focus on scientific impact and/or societal impact is convincing.

In addition to the above, the assessment committee, as part of this criterion, will also take into account:

- if the focus is primarily on scientific impact: how proportional attention will be given to increasing (unforeseen) opportunities for social impact during the course of the project;
- if the focus is primarily on societal impact: how proportional attention will be given to increasing (unforeseen) opportunities for scientific impact during the course of the project.

It is possible to receive a good score for this criterion if the focus of the proposal is on scientific impact, if the focus is on societal impact, and if the focus is spread across both types of impact. The score for this criterion is given independently from the chosen focus; one type of impact is not superior to the other.

The criteria are each assigned a score. Scores are determined based on the NWO score table using a scale of 1 to 9, where '1' is excellent and '9' unsatisfactory.

All proposals are given a weighted average total score for the criteria 1 and 2 and then ranked based on this score. For rounds with five or more proposals, the assessment committee members' scores are standardised for ranking. NWO performs this standardisation based on the median and average deviation.

Via the final score, a proposal should have at least acquired the qualification "very good" to be eligible for funding. For more information on the qualifications, see [Applying for funding, how does it work? | NWO](#).

4.2 Procedure

The assessment procedure for a proposal consists of the following steps (see timeline in subsection 3.1):

- peer review by referees;
- rebuttal;
- allocation to packages and clusters;
- pre-advice by the cluster committees;
- assessment meeting of the cluster committees;
- decision-making.

An external independent assessment committee will be appointed by the NWO Domain Board Science for this round. Members are drawn from science with knowledge of the field. It is the assessment committee's task to assess the proposals received against the assessment criteria. Each proposal is assessed on its own merits.

4.2.1 Peer review referees and non-referees

Before the assessment committee reviews a proposal, NWO will request input from at least two external referees. These are independent advisers who are experts on the proposal's subject matter. They will assess the proposal based on the assessment criteria from the Call for proposals (see subsection 4.1). The referees will not assess the data management section, although they can still provide advice.

Registration of non-referees

An applicant can name up to three individuals they do not want approached as referees. Applicants can register these so-called non-referees in ISAAC when they submit their proposal. NWO will not approach non-referees.

4.2.2 Rebuttal

The main applicant is provided with the anonymised referee reports. They may respond with a rebuttal if desired. Rebuttals must be submitted via ISAAC within five working days of the referee reports' receipt. After this deadline, a rebuttal will not be included in the subsequent stages of the procedure. On receiving the referee reports, an applicant may opt to withdraw their proposal via ISAAC, in which case they should notify NWO of this decision by email as soon as possible. See Chapter 6 for contact details.

4.2.3 Allocation to packages and clusters

A maximum of five times in each round, NWO assesses a package of proposals. Each package consists of a combination of different types of proposals (ENW-M-1, ENW-M-1X, ENW-M-1-Weave, and ENW-M-2) that were accepted in the previous period, have already been through the referee phase and are assessed in competition to one another. Proposals are allocated to a package in the order in which they were received. The package of proposals is distributed over a maximum of three clusters with different focus areas, based on the Domain Science disciplines indicated by the applicants (see section 7.1). For each cluster, a cluster committee is formed. The cluster committees together make up the assessment committee. When composing the cluster committees, NWO chooses experts as best as possible from the ENW disciplines indicated by the applicants.

4.2.4 Pre-advice by the cluster committees

The proposal, referee reports and rebuttal are shared with the assessment committee for review. Preferably, at least two pre-advisers should be appointed for each proposal. The pre-advisers provide written, substantive and reasoned responses to each proposal. They formulate these responses based on the substantive assessment criteria (see subsection 4.1) and give the proposal numerical scores for each assessment criterion. Scores are determined based on the NWO score table using a scale of 1 to 9, where '1' is excellent and '9' unsatisfactory. A proposal's data management section is not assessed and does not affect the decision on whether to award funding. However, the assessment committee may still provide advice on this section.

4.2.5 Assessment meeting of the cluster committees

The assessment committee makes its own assessment based on the available material. The final assessment is guided to an important degree by the referee reports, although the assessment committee will not necessarily adopt these in full. The assessment committee will consider the arguments put forward by the referees, weighing them against each other, and determine whether the rebuttal constitutes a proper response to the points of criticism raised in the referee reports. Unlike the referees, the assessment committee also has insight into the quality of the various other proposals and rebuttals submitted. Consequently, the committee may differ from the referees in its assessment. The assessment committee assigns every proposal a final score, rounded to two decimal places.

Each cluster committee determines a ranking of the applications that are assessed in the relevant cluster and, following the discussion, draws up a written recommendation to the board of the NWO Domain Science about the quality and ranking of the proposals. This recommendation is based on the assessment criteria.

A proposal must achieve an overall rating of at least 'very good' to be eligible for the grant. For more information on the qualifications, see [Applying for funding, how does it work? | NWO](#).

If, after the discussion of the proposals, two or more of the proposals cannot be distinguished from each other based on their weighted total score, then this will result in an ex aequo situation.

4.2.6 Decision-making

The procedures followed and the assessment committee's advice are assessed by the the NWO Domain Board Science. It determines the final ratings and makes a decision on whether to award or reject each proposal. Following this decision, NWO informs the applicant of their proposal's award or rejection. The applicant also receives a letter (by email) with the decision.

Distribution rules for residual budgets

If, within one or more of the three clusters, the residual budget of the relevant budget for that cluster is insufficient to award the next proposal meeting the criteria of the call and the minimum qualification in the corresponding cluster, and the collective residual budget of the clusters is sufficient to allocate at least one additional proposal, the board of the NWO domain Science may decide, for the purpose of optimising the use of the budget per package, to allocate these remaining budgets as follows.

Proposals concerned are those proposals in the three clusters that ended up directly 'below the selection border' in the priority of their respective cluster and hence could not be awarded within the budget of that cluster. If - in accordance with the distribution rules below - the next proposal is a Weave proposal that ended up outside the top 6 in the ranking per cluster, NWO can consult with the partner agency about awarding of the relevant Weave proposal. In this case awarding will depend on the partner agency's financial scope.

- 1) If the collective residual budget is sufficient, the proposal next-in-line in the cluster with the lowest success rate will be awarded. Success rates are determined based on the budget to be awarded to a cluster and the total budget requested per cluster. Success rates are rounded to whole numbers. If the residual budget is insufficient for this proposal, the next proposal from the cluster with the second lowest success rate will be allocated. If the residual budget is also insufficient for that proposal, the next proposal from the cluster with the highest success rate will be awarded.
- 2) When two or three clusters have an equally low success rate, then, in order to promote the number of females in science, the proposal with the highest percentage of female applicants will be awarded. If the remaining budget is insufficient for this proposal, the proposal with the second highest percentage of female applicants will be allocated. If the remaining budget is also insufficient for that proposal, the proposal from the cluster with the lowest percentage of female applicants will be allocated.
- 3) If this is not conclusive, as there are two or more proposals with an equal percentage of female applicants and the residual budget is insufficient to award all of these proposals, then, considering the proposals concerned, the proposals coming from the Domain Science disciplines (as referred to in Section 7.1) with the lowest number of proposals granted in this package will be awarded.

Decision-making ENW-M-1-Weave proposals

For ENW-M-1-Weave proposals, the domain Science board and the partner agency must both reach a positive granting decision to award the proposal. If the partner agency does not reach a positive granting decision, the board of the NWO Domain Science decides to reject the ENW-M-1-Weave proposal as a whole.

4.3 Guidelines and frameworks for assessment

The following guidelines and frameworks apply during the assessment of a proposal.

4.3.1 Code for Dealing with Personal Interests

The [NWO Code for Dealing with Personal Interests](#) applies to all individuals and NWO employees involved in the assessment and/or decision-making process.

4.3.2 Generative AI

The use of generative AI to assess proposals is completely prohibited. More information about NWO's policy on the use of generative AI can be found on the website ([NWO policy on the use of generative artificial intelligence \(GAI\) | NWO](#)).

4.3.3 Diversity and inclusion

NWO strives to achieve an inclusive culture in which there is no place for conscious or unconscious barriers based on cultural, ethnic, or religious background, gender, sexual orientation, health or age ([Diversity and inclusion | NWO](#)). NWO offers referees and assessment committee members guidance on how to ensure an inclusive written assessment and assessment committee meeting ([Inclusive assessment | NWO](#)).

4.3.4 Broad definition of scientific output (DORA)

When assessing the scientific track record of applicants, NWO applies a broad definition of scientific output.

NWO asks assessment committee and referees not to rely on indicators such as the Journal Impact Factor or the h-index when assessing proposals. There should be no mention of such indicators in the proposal. It is, however, permitted to list other scientific products besides publications, such as datasets, patents, software and code.

NWO is a signatory to the 'San Francisco Declaration on Research Assessment' ([DORA](#)), on which this policy is based. DORA is a worldwide initiative that aims to improve the ways in which research and researchers are assessed. DORA contains recommendations for research funders, research organisations, scientific journals and other parties.

4.3.5 Knowledge security

Together, the Dutch knowledge sector, including NWO, and various branches of government have created the National Knowledge Security Guidelines as guidance on how to weigh opportunities and security risks for anyone involved in international collaboration at research organisations. The approach to knowledge security in the Netherlands relies heavily on self-regulation by the knowledge sector.

NWO expects applicants to adhere to the research organisation's knowledge security policy. In case of signs that a proposal or awarded project may present risks to knowledge security, NWO can ask the applicant or project leader to provide insight into risk mitigation measures. Additionally, NWO may impose further conditions to protect knowledge security in the award letter.

The National Knowledge Security Guidelines are available on the central government website at: [Home | National Contact Point for Knowledge Security](#)

4.3.6 Compensation scheme

Force majeure extension scheme

Applicants who are prevented from providing necessary input within the allotted time during the assessment procedure have recourse to the [NWO force majeure extension scheme](#).

4.3.7 Ex aequo

NWO defines ex aequo as a situation in which it is not possible to distinguish between two or more proposals based on their weighted scores. An ex aequo situation is relevant when approaching the limits of the grant cap or selection threshold. The existence of an ex aequo situation is determined as follows. The starting point is the ranking by the assessment committee, with final scores rounded to two decimal places. The score for the lowest-ranked proposal within the limits of the grant cap or the selection threshold is used as a reference score. All proposals with scores within 0.05 of the reference score are taken into consideration. The result is a selection of proposals with scores within 0.10 of each other. In the event of a tied ranking at the limit of the grant cap or selection threshold, in order to promote the representation of women in science the proposal with the highest percentage of female applicants will receive precedence. If this results in another tie, the proposal with the highest score for the 'Scientific quality of the proposal' criterion will be given precedence. If this still does not resolve the situation, the ex aequo situation will be passed on to the NWO Domain Board Science.

4.3.8 Procedure in the event of preferential treatment

NWO will assess a proposal for which a preferential treatment has been requested in the same way as all other proposals. If a proposal with preferential treatment is not awarded with regular funding, but received the NWO qualification "excellent" or "very good", then it will be eligible for funding. For each package of proposals assessed, a maximum of one proposals per cluster can be awarded funding on this basis. This pertains to the highest ranked proposal with preferential treatment that is not awarded regular funding. If there is no proposals with preferential treatment within a cluster or no proposal with preferential treatment meets the conditions for funding, the earmarked preferential treatment budget becomes available for the benefit of the 'regular' proposals in the relevant cluster.

5 After the grant award

This chapter lists the conditions and obligations that apply once the grant has been awarded. As such, it is mainly relevant to applicants with approved proposals.

5.1 Start of the project

Once a proposal has been awarded funding, the main applicant automatically becomes the project leader and point of contact for NWO. The project leaders' research organisation is designated as the main beneficiary and becomes the grant administrator. The project leader and grant administrator share joint responsibility for the execution of the entire project. Co-applicants also play an active role in the project's execution and are project co-leaders.

The project leader for the project receives an award letter on behalf of the NWO Domain Board Science. This letter also notes any specifically required forms and guidelines. The start form and data management plan must be submitted before the project's start. Without these documents, work on the project cannot start. The grant will be paid out in instalments once all start-up requirements have been met.

5.1.1 Start form

A start form must be used to indicate the start of the project. The project leader receives this start form along with the award letter. Project leaders can authorise others to carry out administrative tasks relating to their project in the ISAAC system. For more information about the authorisation scheme for project leaders, go to: [Authorisation scheme for project managers | NWO](#).

5.1.2 Data management plan

Good research goes hand in hand with [responsible data management](#). Before the start of the project, the project leader must elaborate the data management section (see subsection 3.6) into a data management plan. If the referees or assessment committee offered any advice on data management, this may be included. In the plan, the project leader indicates whether use will be made of existing data or whether new data collection will be involved, and how this collection will then be made FAIR, i.e. Findable, Accessible, Interoperable and Reusable.

The data management plan should be checked by a data steward or similar officer at the organisation where the project is to be carried out. The data management plan must have been submitted to NWO via ISAAC before the project start date. NWO will assess the plan. The grant's award is conditional upon approval of the data management plan by NWO. The plan may be adapted in the course of the research.

5.2 Monitoring and project management

The project leader must keep NWO informed of the project's progress throughout. This is achieved in several ways.

5.2.1 Research output

NWO wants to be kept abreast of all the output resulting from the research, both scientific and for a wider audience. The [NWO website](#) offers more information on various forms of output. Project leaders can use the ISAAC system to submit such output.

5.2.2 Project changes

In the event of any changes occurring in the course of the project compared to the approved proposal and budget, the project leader must submit the changes to NWO for approval in advance using a [request for change form](#). See also Article 3.4 of the NWO Grant Rules 2024.

5.3 Guidelines and frameworks for project execution

The following describes the guidelines and frameworks applicable to the project's execution.

5.3.1 Compliance with the National Knowledge Security Guidelines

As with the assessment (see subsection 4.3), the National Knowledge Security Guidelines apply after the grant award. NWO expects project leaders to adhere to the research organisation's knowledge security policy. The grant award letter may contain further conditions to protect knowledge security. The National Knowledge Security Guidelines are available on the central government website at: [National Contact Point for Knowledge Security](#)

5.3.2 Ethical statement or licence

It is the project leader's responsibility to determine whether execution of the proposed project requires an ethical statement or licence. The presence or absence of an ethical statement or licence at the time of application will not impact the proposal's assessment. If an ethical statement or licence does prove necessary for all or part of the research, the project leader must provide NWO with a copy of this statement or licence once the project has been approved and before starting work on the relevant project components. Naturally, the statement or licence must have been issued to be able to work on these components.

5.3.3 Scientific integrity

Research must be conducted in accordance with the standards set out in the 2018 [Netherlands Code of Conduct for Research Integrity](#). In the case of an actual or suspected violation of these standards, the project leader must immediately inform NWO and submit all relevant documents to NWO. Researchers can also report complaints to their research organisation's Scientific Integrity Committee or to the [NWO Scientific Integrity Desk](#).

NWO places a high value on the scientific integrity of the research it funds and exerts itself to prevent and detect any integrity violations. Research irregularities can cause damage directly, for example to the environment or to patients, and prejudice public trust in scientific research as well as trust between individual researchers.

5.3.4 Principles of socially responsible licensing

A project may generate knowledge that is applicable in society. When entering into licensing or transfer agreements for research results developed in this funding round, due consideration must be given to the ten principles of socially responsible licensing provided on the [UMCNL](#) website.

5.3.5 Genetic resources and the Nagoya Protocol

Researchers must take whatever measures are necessary to ensure compliance with the Nagoya Protocol. The Nagoya Protocol aims to ensure fair and equitable sharing of benefits from the utilisation of genetic resources and traditional knowledge associated with genetic resources (Access and Benefit-Sharing; ABS). Researchers who make use of such resources, including in or from other countries, should familiarise themselves with the tenets of the Nagoya Protocol ([ABS Focal Point](#)).

5.3.6 Intellectual property

NWO's policy on intellectual property (IP) can be found in the NWO Grant Rules 2024.

Project leaders must execute a project funded by NWO during their period of employment with the beneficiary research organisation. If a project leader or researcher funded by NWO has multiple employers, the non-beneficiary employers must waive any IP rights arising from the project.

5.4 Completion

Project leaders must submit a substantive and a financial final report to NWO within three months of the project's completion. Failure to submit these reports or to submit them in time can lead to the grant being reduced or withdrawn altogether. The project leader will receive a request by email, along with the relevant deadline. Templates for a basic final report and a financial final report are available at: [Completing a project | NWO](#). If a different final report template applies for the project, the project leader will be provided with this information in due course.

5.4.1 Independent auditor's report on financial statements

To obtain the necessary assurances on the grant's proper expenditure, NWO requires an independent report from an external auditor to arrive at its decision in the following cases:

- the beneficiary of a project grant is not subject to the Education Audit Protocol of the Ministries of Education, Culture and Science and of Economic Affairs (OCW/EZ) and the grant exceeds €125,000;
- a project funded by NWO involves a different provider of public funding than the Ministry of Education, Culture and Science (OCW) and this provider requires an auditor's report. In such cases, applicability of the Education Audit Protocol is not pertinent.

The OCW/EZ Education Audit Protocol applies to legal entities funded by the Ministry of Education, Culture and Science in the following sectors: primary education, secondary education, secondary vocational education and training (MBO) and higher education.

The grant administrator is responsible for arranging an auditor's report within the appropriate time frame. This responsibility remains fully applicable even if the grant administrator has spent part of the grant on another party. Arrangements with the external auditor should be made in good time.

If you have any questions regarding this matter, contact NWO well in advance (see Chapter 6), preferably at the start of the project.

5.5 Research results – Open Science

Open Science is the movement aimed at more open and collaborative research practices in which publications, data, software and other types of academic output are shared at the earliest possible stage and made available for reuse.

Scientific publications about the project must be made available in an Open Access format in accordance with NWO's Open Access Policy Framework. See the NWO website for a list of options to provide open access to various types of publications such as scientific articles, books or book chapters and dissertations. More information on the use of licences is also available on the NWO website. Any costs for Open Access publication should be included as part of the proposal's budget.

NWO-funded research can lead to publications or other relevant research output. If so, the grant administrator must note NWO's funding in the acknowledgements.

5.6 Evaluation

NWO may approach applicants or project leaders to ask them to complete an evaluation of the procedure and/or research programme.

6 Contact

Questions about the funding of proposals

For more information, see [Applying for funding, how does it work? | NWO](#).

Questions about the content of this round

For substantive questions about this round, contact:

Dr. Julia Bakx, tel.: +31 (0)70 349 41 16, e-mail: ENW-M@nwo.nl

Dr. Marjolein Bulk, coordinator, tel: +31 (0)70 344 07 63, e-mail: ENW-M@nwo.nl

Dr. Olivia Muthsam, coordinator, tel.: +31 (0)70 349 43 99, e-mail: ENW-M@nwo.nl

Technical questions about the ISAAC electronic application system

For questions about ISAAC, use the 'Help' button in ISAAC to consult the ISAAC manual. You can also contact the ISAAC helpdesk. The ISAAC helpdesk can be reached Monday to Friday between 10:00 and 17:00 CET/CEST at +31 (0) 70 34 40 600. You can also submit your questions by email to isaac.helpdesk@nwo.nl. You will receive a reply within two working days.

6.1 Other information

NWO processes data from applicants received in the context of this Call for proposals in accordance with the NWO Privacy Statement, [Privacy Statement | NWO](#). In the case of ENW-M-1-Weave proposals, NWO shares, for the purpose of the assessment process, a limited set of personal data with the foreign partner. The set of data shared is listed on the funding page of this Call for proposals. By submitting the proposal, you agree to this.

NWO might approach applicants for an evaluation of the procedure and/or research programme.

7 Annexes

7.1 NWO scientific classification (Disciplines)

Applications only fall within the scope of this call for proposals if they are in or overlap with the fields of mathematics, computer and information science, physical sciences, chemical sciences, earth and related environmental sciences, biological sciences, astronomy and astrophysics. In the application you should state which of the following disciplines (at least one) is applicable and for each discipline you should state a percentage (at least 20%, totaling 100%). The NWO Domain Science office will use the disciplines stated to allocate the proposals submitted across the cluster committees. Of course there are various research areas that cannot be allocated to one discipline. A few (sub-)disciplines are therefore listed under several disciplines in the list below; the disciplines are stated to make it easy to find the (sub-)disciplines.

Mathematics

Algebra, number theory, discrete mathematics
Mathematics of data science
Functional analysis, control theory
Dynamical systems, differential equations
Geometry, topology
Logic, set theory
Numerical analysis, scientific computing
Optimization, operations research
Probability, statistics

Computer and information science

Artificial intelligence
Algorithms, data structures, complexity, and computability
Bioinformatics (computer and information sciences)
Computer graphics, computer simulation, virtual reality
Computer systems, architectures, networks
Data management, data mining and information theory
Information systems, information storage and retrieval, user interfaces, multimedia
Security & privacy
Software engineering, programming languages, formal methods

Physical sciences

Particle and astroparticle physics
Atomic, molecular and optical physics
Condensed matter, materials and nanophysics
Physics of energy
Physics of fluids and soft matter
Physics of life (physical sciences)
Physics of technology and instrumentation
Quantum physics and technology (physical sciences)
Theoretical and mathematical physics
Plasma physics

Chemical sciences

Analytical chemistry

Biochemistry (chemical sciences)
Biotechnology (chemical sciences)
Catalysis (chemical sciences)
Chemical biology
Chemical technology, process technology
Inorganic chemistry
Macromolecular chemistry, polymer chemistry
Materials chemistry
Molecular biology (chemical sciences)
Organic chemistry
Physical chemistry
Structural biology
Synthetic biology
Theoretical, computational and quantum chemistry (chemical sciences)

Earth and related environmental sciences

Atmosphere sciences
Environmental sciences (earth and related environmental sciences)
Geochemistry
Geophysics
Geodesy, physical geography
Geodynamics, sedimentation, tectonics, geomorphology
Geotechnics
Hydrosphere sciences
Marine sciences
Paleoceanography
Paleoclimate
Paleontology, stratigraphy
Petrology, mineralogy, sedimentology
Planetary sciences (earth and related environmental sciences)

Biological sciences

Agronomy
Animal sciences, zoology
Biochemistry (biological sciences)
Bioinformatics (biological sciences)
Biomedical research
Physics of life (biological sciences))
Biotechnology (biological sciences)
Cell biology, histology
Developmental biology
Ecology
Environmental sciences (biological sciences)
Evolutionary biology
Genetics, omics
Immunology, serology
Microbiology, virology, parasitology, infections
Molecular biology (biological sciences)
Neurosciences
Nutrition, food
Organismal biology

Pharmaceutics, pharmacology

Physiology

Plant sciences

Systems biology

Theoretical biology, modelling

[Astronomy, Astrophysics](#)

Galaxies

Gravity and the universe

High-energy astrophysics

Instrumentation - telescopes, detectors and techniques

Planetary sciences (astronomy, astrophysics)

Stars

Very large databases in astronomy: archiving, handling and analysis

7.2 Explanation of budget modules

For applicable salary tables and rates, see [Salary tables | NWO](#).

7.2.1 Personnel at a university in the Kingdom of the Netherlands, university medical centre or research organisation

For personnel employed by a university in the Kingdom of the Netherlands, university medical centre or other research organisation as referred to in Article 1.1, first section, subsections c to h of the NWO Grant Rules 2024, salary costs may be included for the following positions.

PhD student

A PhD student is appointed for 1.0 FTE for a period of 48 months. An equivalent of 48 full-time months is also possible, e.g. an appointment for 0.8 FTE of 60 months. It is not possible to request funding for a PhD student who was already working on the proposed project before the grant award.

Use the rates for PhD students from the UNL and UMCNL salary tables. There is a one-off personal bench fee of €5,000 available for each PhD student, aimed at promoting their scientific career.

Postdoc

A postdoc is appointed for a specific time and FTE.

Use the rates for senior scientific personnel from the UNL salary tables and the rates for postdocs at a university medical centre from the UMCNL salary tables.

It is not possible to request funding for a postdoc who was already working on the proposed project before the grant award.

There is a one-off personal bench fee of €5,000 available for postdoc positions with an appointment of at least 12 months and 0.5 FTE, aimed at promoting their scientific career.

Non-scientific personnel

Funding may be requested for non-scientific personnel required for the project's execution. Examples include programmers, technical assistants or analysts and project managers. Non-scientific personnel's deployment must be described in the proposal.

Depending on the job level, a choice is made from the UNL or UMCNL salary tables for NWP-mbo, NWP-hbo and NWP-academic. No one-off personal benchfee is available for NWP.

7.2.2 Scientific personnel at foreign research organisations

Funding may be requested for salary costs of personnel at a foreign research organisation contributing to the project. The foreign research organisation must comply with the definition of a research organisation as referred to in Article 1.1, subsections 4 and 5 of the NWO Grant Rules 2024 and with the cumulative conditions listed under 'Conditions for foreign research organisations'.

Compelling justification is required, demonstrating how the researcher at the foreign research organisation contributes specific expertise to the project that is not available at the required level in the Netherlands. The assessment committee will evaluate the justification as part of the 'Scientific quality of the proposal' criterion. No justification is required if NWO has concluded a bilateral 'Money Follows Cooperation' agreement with the national research council of the country where the foreign research organisation is located. The [NWO website](#) contains an overview of research councils that have such an agreement with NWO. NWO will not award funding to co-applicants in countries subject to national or international sanction legislation and rules.

The main applicant receives the grant and is responsible for transferring grant funds to the co-applicant's foreign research organisation and for the financial reporting on the use of the foreign portion of the grant. The exchange rate risk is borne by the applicant. Gains or losses resulting from currency fluctuations are not eligible for funding.

Use the UNL rates, multiplied by the [correction coefficients per country](#). These are the maximum rates. No personal bench fee is provided.

If more than €125,000 is requested per organisation within this budget module, the final financial statement must be accompanied by an audit report.

Conditions for foreign research organisations

The organisation must be:

- a foundation, association or an organisation or body established and governed by public law (in Dutch: *publiekrechtelijke rechtspersoon*), or at least its equivalent in the country of establishment of the foreign organisation (all other legal forms, including private and public limited companies – or at least its equivalent in the country of establishment of the foreign organisation – are excluded);
- be principally engaged in conducting fundamental research, industrial research or experimental development independently or in the broad dissemination of the results of its own research activities through education, publications or knowledge transfer;
- be able to declare that the organisation keeps separate accounts with regard to economic/non-economic activities and that companies with decisive influence on the organisation do not have preferential access to the organisation's research results.

Note: Prior to submission of a proposal, NWO will assess whether the foreign organisation complies with Article 1.1, subsections 4 and 5 of the NWO Grant Rules 2024 and is thus eligible to participate as a co-applicant based on the above conditions.

This assessment also helps to ensure NWO's compliance with regulations prohibiting state aid.

To enable the assessment to be carried out, the main applicant must submit the following documents for the foreign organisation (or organisations) by email to ENW-M@nwo.nl no later than twenty working days before the submission:

- a recent extract from the Chamber of Commerce or from an equivalent register in the foreign organisation's country of establishment;
- a deed of establishment and/or current articles of association;
- the most recently available annual accounts, including an audit report²;

² No audit report is necessary for organisations not legally required to have their annual accounts audited. However, such organisations must be able to provide proof of exemption from this legal requirement.

- a Research Organisation Statement completed by the foreign organisation. This statement is available on the funding page of this Call for proposals.

Documents must be in English or Dutch. Other relevant documents may also be included. NWO may also request additional information if the above documents do not allow for adequate determination of the organisation's eligibility to act as co-applicant.

If the intended co-applicant's organisation has already been assessed and found to comply with these conditions as part of a different NWO programme, please contact NWO at the above email address as soon as possible to determine whether further assessment is necessary.

If the main applicant fails to submit the documents required for this assessment on time, NWO will not accept the organisation as a co-applicant.

7.2.3 Materials

Funding may be requested for all project-specific costs pertaining to such items as consumables, purchasing of services, materials, small instruments, access to facilities in the Netherlands or abroad, software and research resources with no economic value after use. This module also covers national and international travel and accommodation costs for everyone working on the project, including visiting researchers from abroad, costs for the organisation of (international) workshops and symposiums, data management costs, publications and costs in the context of citizen science. A maximum of 50% of the material budget requested from NWO may be applied to work by third parties such as laboratory analyses, data collection, etc.

For national and international travel, only the costs of second class or economy fares will be covered. For publications, see the provisions on Open Science in subsection 5.5. Costs for an audit report may only be included for research organisations not subject to the OCW Education Audit Protocol and for up to €5,000 per audit report.

Costs cannot be included for:

- organisational infrastructure and overhead, including a fully operational workplace, accommodation, office automation, human resource management, commuting expenses, training, facilities services, HR consulting, health and safety, documentary information services and working-from-home allowance;
- use and maintenance of internally developed scientific infrastructure;
- regular teaching and educational activities.

Note: If funding is being requested for the above-mentioned project-specific costs at foreign organisations, these organisations must be assessed in accordance with subsection 7.2.1, *Scientific personnel at foreign research organisations*.

7.2.4 Investments

Funding may be requested for all project-specific resources for the purpose of research and costs relating to the establishment or further development of scientific infrastructure that will retain economic value after use or can be re-used. The beneficiary will own the research resources after the project's completion. If the beneficiary achieves profits through the beneficial ownership of the research resources, these profits must be invested in the beneficiary's primary activities as referred to in Article 3.1.4, subsection 2 of the NWO Grant Rules 2024. This concerns purchases of equipment that will remain valuable for the conduct of research and investments in the establishment or (further) development of scientific infrastructure. Salary costs for such investments can be included as personnel costs.

Costs for investments must be adequately specified and motivated in the proposal.

Eligible for funding:

- costs for investments in scientific equipment;
- costs for investments in datasets;
- salary costs for employees with essential technical expertise necessary for the development or construction of an investment.

Not eligible for funding:

- costs for infrastructural facilities that can be considered part of the standard infrastructure, such as a fully operational workplace, accommodation, office automation, human resource management, commuting expenses, training, facilities services, HR consulting, health and safety, documentary information services and working-from-home allowance;
- data collections and any associated software and bibliographies that are already available in other ways;
- other personnel costs, including personnel costs required to operate a facility and to use it for research;
- costs for the maintenance and use of the equipment in a project. Costs for the use of equipment in a project can be included via the material budget.

7.2.5 Knowledge utilisation

The budget applied for must be adequately specified in the proposal. Use the provisions for Personnel and Materials to determine the correct rates.

It is possible to allocate up to 5% of the grant amount for this module. Use of this module is not mandatory. Examples of possible costs include, but are not limited to, the design of teaching materials, a feasibility study to explore possible applications, costs for the submission of patent applications or engaging a business developer.

Note: If requesting funding for the above-mentioned project-specific costs for foreign organisations, these organisations must be assessed before submission in accordance with subsection 7.2.2, *Scientific personnel at foreign research organisations*.

7.3 Indexation

Applicable rates are based on the date of the decision. If indicated, NWO may conduct an official one-time indexation of salary costs when awarding a grant. This indexation is based on the date on which the rates go into force. If rates are announced later than the date of entry into force, the announcement date is used. Generally speaking, rates go into force on 1 July for the Universities of the Netherlands (UNL), on 1 August for the University Medical Centres of The Netherlands (UMCNL) and on 1 January for the Manual tariffs Dutch Government (HOT).

The official indexation does not affect the grant cap or the maximum amount per proposal. The grant cap and maximum amount will remain unchanged during the assessment procedure. The grant amount is indexed at the time of the award.

If co-funding is required or permitted, the official indexation will not affect the requirements regarding supporting contributions and co-funding, nor any IP rights arising from the co-funding.

7.4 Procedure Weave proposals with NWO as partner agency

This section describes the conditions and procedure for Weave proposals where NWO acts as partner agency. Researchers from the Netherlands can submit a bilateral research project together with a partner from Germany, Luxembourg or Flanders to DFG, FNR or FWO, respectively. This foreign research funder will act as lead agency and handle and assess the submitted proposal. NWO is the partner agency in this case. The bilateral application and the foreign researchers must meet the conditions of the funding instrument designated by DFG, FNR or FWO. The applicant from the Netherlands and the Dutch part of the requested budget must meet the conditions of this Call for proposals (the Dutch designated funding instrument), as further specified in this section.

The designated Weave funding channels for basic research at the lead agencies can be accessed via the links below:

[Germany via DFG](#) (German Research Foundation)

[Luxembourg via FNR](#) (Luxembourg National Research Fund)

[Flanders via FWO](#) (Scientific Research Fund)

7.4.1 Available budget

The subsidy ceiling for the NWO-part of Weave proposals where NWO is the partner agency and submitted to DFG, FNR or FWO (DFG, FNR or FWO is lead agency) is €11,000,000.

7.4.2 Submission deadlines

Applications with DFG as lead agency and NWO as partner agency may be submitted to DFG at any time during the period **from 18 August 2026 to 31 July 2027**. If a proposal is submitted to DFG, the deadline for submitting the administrative submission (see section 7.4.5) to NWO is **five working days after submission to DFG, at 14:00:00 CE(S)T**.

The deadline for submitting applications with FNR as lead agency and NWO as partner agency follows the deadline of the FNR CORE Programme. The exact deadline is at the time of publication of this call not yet known, but is expected to be in April 2027. If a proposal is submitted to FNR, the deadline for submitting the administrative submission (see section 7.4.5) to NWO is five working days after submission to FNR, at 14:00:00 CE(S)T.

The deadline for submitting applications with FWO as lead agency and NWO as partner agency is 1 April 2027, at 17:00:00 CEST. If an application is submitted to FWO, the deadline for submitting the administrative submission (see section 7.4.5.) to NWO is five working days after submission to FWO, at 14:00:00 CE(S)T.

7.4.3 Who can submit

The conditions described in section 3.1 apply to Dutch co-applicants to a foreign Weave proposal.

7.4.4 What can be requested

In a Weave proposal, the NWO side may apply for the equivalent of an ENW-M-1 proposal, see section 3.2. This means that maximum one Dutch applicant can be involved and that a maximum of €400,000 may be applied for, from which one temporary scientific position (PhD student (not possible in case of a Weave proposal with DFG*) or postdoc) will be funded in combination with the other available budget modules. The module for Scientific personnel at foreign research organisations is not available in this funding form. Only apply for what is essential to carry out the project. A further explanation of the budget modules can be found in the appendix to this Call for proposals (section 7.2).

*Funding can be applied for a maximum of 3 years in a Weave proposal with DFG as lead agency. Accordingly, it is **not possible to apply for** a Dutch PhD student in a Weave proposal with DFG as lead agency. Funding for a maximum of 4 years can be applied for in a Weave proposal with FNR or FWO as lead agency.

Foreign applicants follow the conditions of the own funding agency. The budget claimed at the lead agency does not count towards the maximum of the budget claimed at NWO and vice versa.

7.4.5 Preparing and submitting the (administrative) submission

The lead applicant from Germany, Luxembourg or Flanders submits the joint proposal to DFG, FNR or FWO according to the terms and conditions of DFG, FNR or FWO.

To prepare and submit the application to DFG, please check [the website of DFG](#).

To prepare and submit the application to the FNR, the lead applicant follows the steps as described by FWO. At the time of publishing this Call, there is no webpage with instructions available. We recommend you to keep an eye on [the general Weave page on the FNR website](#).

To prepare and submit the application to the FWO, the lead applicant follows the steps as described by FWO. At the time of publishing this Call, there is no webpage with instructions available. We recommend you to keep an eye on [the Weave page on the FWO website](#).

Please note that a profile or account may still have to be created for you as a co-applicant in the lead agency system. It is important to start with your application in on time.

The deadline for submitting the administrative submission to NWO is five working days after submission of the proposal to the lead agency. To prepare the administrative submission to NWO, the Dutch co-applicant goes through the following steps:

- submits the original application as submitted to DFG, FNR or FWO, saved as pdf, with the attachments required at NWO in ISAAC;
 - Note: for the administrative application to NWO, the Dutch applicant acts as the main applicant in ISAAC. The foreign applicant(s), including the foreign main applicant, must be registered as co-applicants in ISAAC;
 - Does an applicant work at an organisation that is not included in the ISAAC database? You can report this via relatiebeheer@nwo.nl so that the organisation can be added. This will take several days. It is therefore important that you report this at least one week before the deadline.
- in ISAAC, the Dutch applicant fills in all the requested information, including the [NWO disciplines](#) and a summary for non-experts in Dutch and English; NWO will publish this summary for non-experts along with the press release about the grant awards. It should have a length of 50–100 words and be written for a general audience. Due to intellectual property concerns, no scientific summary is published.

It is mandatory to upload the following annexes to the proposal in ISAAC:

- Budget (only for funds requested from NWO) (Excel);
- NWO as partner agency form.

Optional annex only:

- Declaration of appointment and project supervision.

Always use the templates provided by NWO for all annexes. Annexes other than those listed above are not permitted. All attachments, with the exception of the budget, must be submitted as PDF files (without security). The budget must be submitted as an Excel file in ISAAC.

You must write your application in English

Submitting an administrative submission can only be done through the web application ISAAC. Proposals not submitted through ISAAC will not be considered. Dutch co-applicants are required to submit the administrative submission through their own personal ISAAC account.

It is important to start with your application in ISAAC on time:

- if you do not yet have an ISAAC account, then you should create this on time to prevent any possible registration problems;
- any new organisations must also be added to ISAAC by NWO;
- you also need to submit other details online.

Applications submitted after the deadline will not be taken into consideration by NWO.

For technical questions, please contact the ISAAC helpdesk, see contact (Chapter 6).

7.4.6 Formal requirements for submission

The lead agency assesses whether the proposal meets the formal conditions of the lead agency. NWO tests the administrative submission against the formal conditions below. Only if your administrative submission meets these can it be considered. Please note that NWO may approach you after the submission to make any administrative corrections. You will have one opportunity to make the corrections; you will have five working days to do so.

The conditions are:

- The Dutch co-applicant meets the (additional) conditions set out in section 3.2;
- the Weave application has been submitted to one of the selected review boards (DFG)/ research areas (FNR)/ expert panels (FNR) (see section 7.4.12, 7.4.13 or 7.4.14);
- the administrative submission has been submitted via the ISAAC account of the Dutch co-applicant;
- the administrative submission was received before the set deadline;
- the Dutch application budget has been drawn up in accordance with the conditions of this Call for proposals;
- all required NWO attachments have been completed and submitted in full and in accordance with the instructions and conditions of this Call for proposals, after any request for additions or amendments.

7.4.7 Grant conditions

The Dutch part of the Weave application is subject to the [NWO Grant Rules 2024](#) and [Approval of Funding for Scientific Research](#).

7.4.8 Assessment procedure

The lead agency assessment procedure is followed, as set out in the designated Weave funding channels for basic research at the respective lead agencies. NWO has no further role in the assessment.

7.4.9 Decision-making

The foreign lead agency submits the advice of their assessment committee to the NWO domain Science board. The domain Science board reviews the procedure followed and the advice of the assessment committee. Subsequently, the domain Science board decides whether to accept or reject the Dutch part of the proposal.

It follows from the agreed Weave principles that Weave applications submitted abroad must be among the top 20% of proposals to be eligible for funding. The lead agency may consult with NWO on awarding of proposals that finish outside the top 20%. In such cases awarding will depend on the financial space available to NWO and the lead agency. Funding a Weave proposal is only possible if the foreign lead agency and NWO as partner agency reach the same positive granting decision. If the lead agency rejects the proposal, the domain Science board will also reject the proposal.

7.4.10 Grant obligations

For Weave proposals, in addition to the grant conditions listed in section 7.4.7, the conditions and obligations that apply after the award of the grant for the Dutch part of the Weave project, as described in Chapter 5, also apply.

7.4.11 Further information and questions on content eligibility

More information on Weave can be found [here](#). For this Call for proposals, your Weave proposal must fit within the Science domain and be submitted to one of the selected review boards (DFG)/ research areas (FNR)/ expert panels (FWO). If in doubt about the suitability of the content, you are advised to contact the programme's contact person at NWO, DFG, FNR or FWO well before the deadline. This person can advise you on the substantive fit of your application to this call. For contact details of the contact person at NWO, see section 6.

7.4.12 Selected review boards at DFG as lead agency

If DFG is chosen as Lead Agency, the application must be submitted to one of the following [review boards](#):

Life Sciences (selected Review Boards):

- 2.11 Basic Research in Biology and Medicine
- 2.12 Plant Sciences
- 2.13 Zoology
- 2.21 Microbiology, Virology and Immunology
- 2.22 Medicine (**only selected areas**):
 - 2.22-03 Human Genetics
 - 2.22-05 Nutritional Sciences
 - 2.22-06 Pathology
 - 2.22-09 Pharmacology
 - 2.22-17 Endocrinology, Diabetology, Metabolism
 - 2.22-32 Medical Physics, Biomedical Technology
- 2.23 Neurosciences (**only selected areas**):
 - 2.23-01 Developmental Neurobiology
 - 2.23-02 Molecular Biology and Physiology of Neurons and Glial Cells
 - 2.23-03 Experimental and Theoretical Network Neuroscience
 - 2.23-04 Cognitive, Systems and Behavioural Neurobiology
 - 2.23-05 Experimental Models for the Understanding of Nervous System Diseases
 - 2.23-06 Molecular and Cellular Neurology and Neuropathology
 - 2.23-08 Human Cognitive and Systems Neuroscience
 - 2.23-09 Biological Psychiatry
- 2.31 Agriculture, Forestry and Veterinary Medicine (**only selected areas**):
 - 2.31-01 Soil Sciences
 - 2.31-02 Plant Breeding and Plant Pathology
 - 2.31-03 Plant Cultivation, Plant Nutrition, Agricultural Technology
 - 2.31-04 Ecology of Land Use
 - 2.31-07 Animal Breeding, Animal Nutrition, Animal Husbandry
 - 2.31-08 Veterinary Medical Science

Natural Sciences (all review boards)

- 3.11 Molecular Chemistry
- 3.12 Chemical Solid State and Surface Research
- 3.13 Physical Chemistry
- 3.14 Analytical Chemistry
- 3.15 Biological Chemistry and Food Chemistry
- 3.16 Polymer Research
- 3.17 Theoretical Chemistry
- 3.21 Condensed Matter Physics
- 3.22 Statistical Physics, Nonlinear Dynamics, Complex Systems Soft and Fluid Matter, Biological Physics
- 3.23 Optics, Quantum Optics and Physics of Atoms, Molecules and Plasmas
- 3.24 Particles, Nuclei and Fields
- 3.25 Astrophysics and Astronomy
- 3.31 Mathematics
- 3.41 Atmospheric Science, Oceanography and Climate Research
- 3.42 Geology and Palaeontology
- 3.43 Geophysics and Geodesy
- 3.44 Mineralogy, Petrology and Geochemistry
- 3.45 Geography (**only selected areas**):
 - 3.45-01 Physical Geography
- 3.46 Water Research

Engineering Sciences (selected Review Boards)

- 4.21 Process Engineering and Technical Chemistry (**only selected areas**):
 - 4.21-01 Chemical and Thermal Process Engineering
 - 4.21-02 Technical Chemistry
 - 4.21-03 Mechanical Process Engineering
 - 4.21-04 Biological Process Engineering
- 4.22 Fluid Mechanics, Technical Thermodynamics and Thermal Energy Engineering (**only selected areas**):
 - 4.22-03 Fluid Mechanics
- 4.31 Materials Engineering
- 4.32 Materials Science
- 4.43 Computer Science

7.4.13 Selected research areas at FNR as Lead Agency

If FNR is chosen as Lead Agency, the application must be submitted to one of the following research areas:

Physical Sciences and Engineering:

- PE1 Mathematics
- PE2 Fundamental Constituents of Matter
- PE3 Condensed Matter Physics
- PE4 Physical and Analytical Chemical Sciences
- PE5 Synthetic Chemistry and Materials
- PE6 Computer Science and Informatics
- PE9 Universe Sciences
- PE10 Earth System Science

Life Sciences:

LS1 Molecular and Structural Biology and Biochemistry

LS2 Genetics, Genomics, Bioinformatics and Systems Biology

LS3 Cellular and Developmental Biology

LS4 Physiology, Pathophysiology and Endocrinology (**only selected subdomains**)

LS4_3 Endocrinology

LS4_4 Ageing

LS4_5 Metabolism, biological basis of metabolism related disorders

LS4_6 Cancer and its biological basis

LS5 Neurosciences and Neural Disorders (**only selected subdomains**)

LS5_1 Neuroanatomy and neurophysiology

LS5_2 Molecular and cellular neuroscience

LS5_3 Neurochemistry and neuropharmacology

LS5_4 Sensory systems (e.g. visual system, auditory system)

LS5_5 Mechanisms of pain

LS5_6 Developmental neurobiology

LS5_7 Cognition (e.g. learning, memory, emotions, speech)

LS5_8 Behavioural neuroscience (e.g. sleep, consciousness, handedness)

LS5_9 Systems neuroscience

LS5_10 Neuroimaging and computational neuroscience

LS5_11 Neurological disorders (e.g. Alzheimer's disease, Huntington's disease, Parkinson's disease)

LS6 Immunity and Infection

LS8 Evolutionary, Population and Environmental Biology

7.4.14 Selected expert panels at FWO as Lead Agency

If FWO is chosen as Lead Agency, the application must be submitted to one of the following expert panels:

Biological Sciences (all expert panels)

Bio1: Molecular and Cellular Biology

Bio2: Functional Biology

Bio3: Biodiversity, Ecology and Evolution

Bio4: Applied Biological Sciences

Medical Sciences (selected expert panels)

Med1: Pharmaceutical Sciences and Medical Biochemistry

Med2: Bio-informatics, Genetics and Functional Genomics, Developmental and Stem Cell Biology

Med3: Immunology and Microbiology

Med4: Cancer Research

Med5: Neurology, Neuroscience, ENT medicine, Ophthalmology, Psychiatry

Med6: Respiratory System, Cardiovascular System, Hematology, Nephrology

Med7: Endocrinology, Gastroenterology, Hepatology, Metabolism and Nutrition, Reproduction, Urogenital System

Science and Technology (selected expert panels)

W&T1: Mathematical Sciences

W&T2: Physics

W&T3: Condensed Matter

W&T4: Chemistry

W&T5: Computer Science & Information Technology

W&T6: Chemical and Materials Engineering

W&T8: Sciences of the Earth and Space

7.5 Glossary International cooperation

Administrative submission: the submission of the bilateral proposal to the partner agency.

Bilateral application: an application involving two research funders.

German (co-)applicant: an applicant who meets DFG's submission requirements. This term therefore does not refer to the applicant's nationality.

ENW-M-1-Weave proposal: a Weave proposal submitted to NWO as lead agency.

Lead agency: the research funder to which a bilateral application is submitted and that is responsible for assessing the application.

Luxembourgish (co-)applicant: an applicant who meets FNR's submission requirements. This term therefore does not refer to the applicant's nationality.

Dutch (co-)applicant: an applicant working at the institutions defined in section 3.1. This term therefore does not refer to the applicant's nationality.

Partner agency: the research funder involved in a bilateral application who is not responsible for assessing the bilateral application.

Flemish (co-)applicant: an applicant who meets FWO's submission requirements. This term therefore does not refer to the applicant's nationality.

Weave: Weave is a bottom-up cross-European initiative set up by European research funders - and embedded in Science Europe - within which 12 European research funders currently fund cross-border research with partner countries, see <https://Weave-research.net/>.

Weave proposal: a bilateral proposal submitted to NWO, DFG, FNR or FWO under the Weave principle.

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